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Project Management 7.7

Project Closure

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Learning Outcomes

- By the end of this week, you will be able to:
  - Give good practice closure examples
  - Know how to avoid bad practice
  - Understand stakeholder communication is key

Project Closure

- Apart from the PIR, the end of a project also means we need to close down the temporary structure we created to manage deployment
- A controlled project closure ensures we don’t waste the resources we brought together
  - Knowledge and expertise
  - People
  - Equipment and other physical resources.

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Closing a project

- A project has a beginning (Project Start-up) a middle (the iterative loop of Planning, Managing, Controlling, Reporting and Re-planning) and an end (Project Closure)
- Turning up to a meeting that no one else attends is not the way to find out a project has finished! The project should be formally closed to ensure that:
  - The users/customers have formally accepted all outcomes
  - Operational procedures are in place

Closure Responsibilities

- The Project Manager should obtain confirmation from the Senior User or User Group that the final product or outcome of the project meets the acceptance criteria.
- The Project Board/Sponsor needs to review the outcome of the project, particularly where there is no separate Benefits Manager in place.
- Lessons Learned log needs to be reviewed and turned into a report for publication
- The Project Board should ensure that there is an agreement by project board members, user group members and the project team to be involved in a post-project review.

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Look Forward

- L7.8 The project benefits